

# Jiawei Fan

Brandeis University | Ph.D. Candidate in Financial Economics

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## EDUCATION

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|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>Brandeis University, Waltham, MA, USA</b>                  | 2022 - present |
| <i>PhD Candidate in International Economics and Finance</i>   |                |
| <b>University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong, China</b>              | 2021 – 2022    |
| <i>MA in Economics</i>                                        |                |
| <b>Lehigh University, Bethlehem, PA, USA</b>                  | 2015 – 2017    |
| <i>MA in Statistics</i>                                       |                |
| <b>South China University of Technology, Guangzhou, China</b> | 2011 – 2015    |
| <i>BA in Applied Mathematics</i>                              |                |

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Asset pricing, Financial Economics, Econometrics

## WORKING PAPERS

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### **Two Heads Are Better Than One: t-Statistics and Monotonicity in the Factor Zoo**

*(Job Market Paper, sole-authored)*

This paper shows that two in-sample diagnostics used to judge factor quality the conventional t-statistic and monotonicity capture distinct information and enhance predictive power when combined. The two measures are nearly un-correlated in-sample ( $\rho = -0.08$ ). Factors with the highest in-sample summed rank across both dimensions ( $\geq 70$ th percentile) deliver 33.4/34.2 bps/month in out-of-sample return/alpha, while factors with the lowest summed rank ( $\leq 30$ th percentile) deliver only 10.2/10.9 bps/month. High-summed-rank factors also perform better in real-time trading: a strategy built on the top 30% by summed rank dominates on a certainty-equivalent basis at every risk-aversion level considered and continues to hold up once trading costs and market impact are priced in. Finally, the combined strategy results in higher diversification in factor rotation. [\[SSRN Link\]](#)

### **Calendar Effects of Asset Pricing Factors, with Sida Li and Wanyu Miao**

The literature finds that U.S. equity returns are higher overnight, on Fridays, in January, around the turn-of-the-month, and during macro announcements (e.g., FOMC, GDP, NFP, and ISM releases). We replicate 153 long-short factors and find that their premia are lower in all of these periods. On average, a factor loses 2.01 bps overnight but earns 5.45 bps intraday ( $t = 8.54$ ); earns 5.77 bps on Mondays, 3.44 bps on midweek days, and 1.24 bps on Fridays (midweek–Monday difference:  $t = -7.06$ ; Friday–midweek difference:  $t = -5.34$ ); earns 0.22 bps in January but 3.71 bps on non-January days ( $t = 3.66$ ); earns 1.89 bps during turn of-the-month days versus 3.61 bps on other days ( $t = 6.01$ ); earns 2.99 bps during three-day windows surrounding major macroeconomic announcements, compared with 3.71 bps on other days ( $t = 4.62$ ). The results are robust in-sample and out-of-sample. Our results are consistent with sentiment-driven mispricing, as we find that the calendar effects of factors are stronger when news sentiment is high. [\[SSRN Link\]](#)

*Presented at:* Chinese Economists Society (CES) China Annual Conference 2026

### **Stale Data, Persistent Alpha, with Sida Li**

Anomaly returns concentrate around information releases, suggesting mispricing that is corrected as news arrives. We replicate 94 accounting-based anomalies with accounting data lagged by up to five years. Alpha decays slowly: median

monthly CAPM alphas are 36 basis points at the four-month lag and 28 with year-old data, robust out of sample and positive internationally. An equal-weighted book of year-old factors earns 19 basis points monthly ( $t = 4.9$ ); the four-month minus-twelve-month spread earns 8 ( $t = 6.0$ ) and is shrinking. The evidence limits explanations in which returns vanish once information is public and is consistent with a persistent characteristic premium. [\[SSRN Link\]](#)

## PAPER PRESENTATIONS

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Chinese Economists Society (CES) China Annual Conference 2026

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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|                                                                                  |             |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Teaching Assistant, Brandeis University</b>                                   | Fall 2025   |
| <i>Statistics for Economic Analysis</i> by Tymon Słoczyński                      |             |
| <b>Teaching Assistant, Brandeis University</b>                                   | Fall 2025   |
| <i>Introduction to Machine Learning with Economic Applications</i> by Yinchu Zhu |             |
| <b>Teaching Assistant, Brandeis University</b>                                   | Fall 2024   |
| <i>Applied Econometrics with R</i> by Davide Pettenuzzo                          |             |
| <b>Teaching Assistant, Brandeis University</b>                                   | Spring 2023 |
| <i>Introduction to Natural Language Processing</i> by Yeabin Moon                |             |
| <b>Teaching Assistant, Lehigh University</b>                                     | Fall 2016   |
| <i>Calculus III</i> by Terry Napier                                              |             |

## WORK EXPERIENCE

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| <b>Research Assistant, Brandeis Online Learning Lab</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 2023 - present |
| <b>Senior Associate, KMK Consulting Inc.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | 2017 – 2021    |
| <i>Publications:</i> Real-World Treatment Patterns Among Patients with Mycosis Fungoides or Sezary Syndrome in the United States<br>with Yang Zhao, Jackson Tang, Huanxue Zhou. Published in ISPOR 2021, Value in Health, Volume 24, Issue 5, S1 (May 2021) <a href="#">[Publication Link]</a> |                |

## GRANTS, AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS

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|----------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Brandeis University Doctoral Fellowship                  | 2022-2027 |
| Provost Doctoral Research Award                          | 2025      |
| Institute of Education Sciences Grant                    | 2024      |
| Third Prize in Mathematical Contest in Modeling (COMAP)  | 2014      |
| Second Prize in Mathematical Contest in Modeling (COMAP) | 2013      |

## LANGUAGES & TOOLS

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|                                     |                                    |
|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Programming and Scripting Languages | R, Python, SQL, SAS, Matlab        |
| Machine Learning Tools              | PyTorch, TensorFlow, Scikit-learn  |
| Dashboarding & Visualization Tools  | Tableau                            |
| Languages                           | Chinese (native), English (fluent) |

## REFERENCES

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Professor Blake LeBaron

Professor of Finance, School of Business and Economics, Brandeis University  
blebaron@brandeis.edu

**Professor Sida Li**

Assistant Professor of Finance, School of Business and Economics, Brandeis University  
sidali@brandeis.edu

**Professor Anna Schebina**

Professor of Finance, School of Business and Economics, Brandeis University  
ascherbina@brandeis.edu